

*Hyemoschus aquaticus*

Water chevrotain



Location W. to C. Africa

Length 23¼–40¼ in (60–102 cm)

Tail 2¾–4¼ in (7.2–10.9 cm)

Weight 15–35 lb (7–16 kg)

Social unit Individual/Group

Status Least concern



Generally found within 820 ft (250 m) of water, this chevrotain is dark olive-brown, with white markings that include spots on the back, 1–3 stripes along each flank, and chin, throat, and chest bands. It has short legs and ears, a stout body, and swims well, which enables it to escape land-based predators successfully most of the time, but incurs the risk of crocodile attack. Water chevrotains forage for leaves and fallen fruit. Males live singly, while females and their young form small groups.

*Moschiola meminna*

White-spotted chevrotain



Location Sri Lanka

Length 20–23 in (50–58 cm)

Tail 1¼ in (3 cm)

Weight 6½ lb (3 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



back, and striped flanks and throat; however, these pale markings are less distinct than those of the water chevrotain (above) and the main coat color is brown with tiny yellow speckles. Males compete using their sharp, tusklike upper canine teeth. The single young is born after a gestation of 5 months.



Like other chevrotains (mouse deer), this species has 4 fully developed toes on each foot (true deer have 2). It skulks in cover, preferring rocky patches within tropical rain forest. Nocturnal and solitary, it has a spotted

*Moschus chrysogaster*

Alpine musk deer



Location S. Asia

Length 28–39 in (70–100 cm)

Tail ¾–2¼ in (2–6 cm)

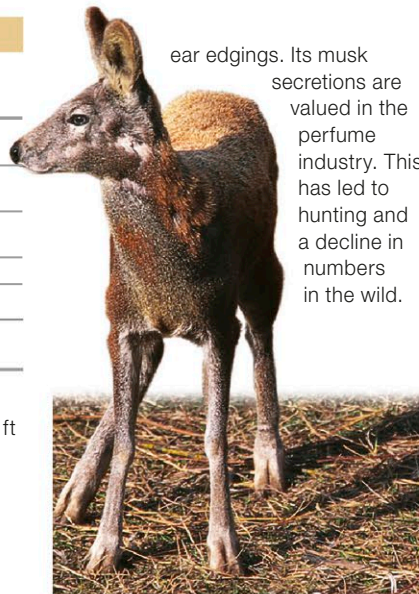
Weight 24–40 lb (11–18 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Endangered



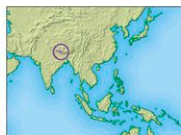
An inhabitant of rocky, forested slopes at an altitude of 8,600–11,900 ft (2,600–3,600 m), the musk deer has well-developed side toes to climb rocks and even trees, and to move through soft snow. Its coat is rich, dark brown mottled with gray, paler underneath, with a whitish chin and



ear edgings. Its musk secretions are valued in the perfume industry. This has led to hunting and a decline in numbers in the wild.

*Muntiacus putaoensis*

Leaf muntjac



Location S. Asia

Length c. 30 in (80 cm)

Tail c. 3 in (8 cm)

Weight 26–26½ lb (11.8–12.1 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Data deficient



Initially thought to be the juvenile of another species, specimens of this animal were later shown to belong to an entirely new species of muntjac. The common name comes from local knowledge that the deer is so small it can be wrapped inside a single leaf. It is a primitive species that lives in the dense forests of northern Myanmar and adjacent parts of India. The leaf muntjac differs from other muntjacs in that both male and female have large canine tusks. The newborns have unspotted coats.

*Dama dama*

Common fallow deer



Location Europe

Length 4¼–5 ft (1.3–1.5 m)

Tail 6¼–7¼ in (16–19 cm)

Weight 285–595 lb (130–270 kg)

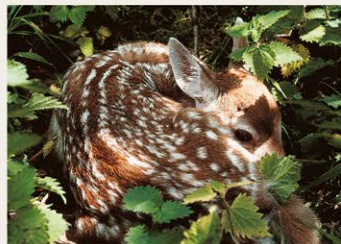
Social unit Group

Status Least concern



Common fallow deer have long been kept semidomesticated for their beauty and meat, and have been introduced to the Americas, Africa, and Australia. They are active at twilight, consuming many plant foods, from grasses to acorns. Herds may exceed 100. Bucks rut to establish a small patch of land, where they mate.

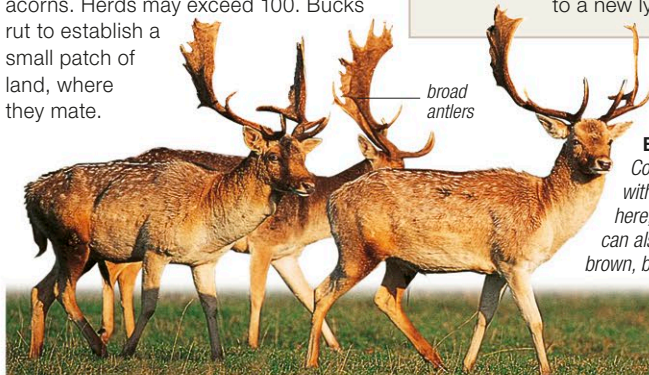
LYING UP



The fallow deer fawn, like most young deer, “lies up” in thick vegetation or among leaf litter, as the mother feeds. The fawn’s instincts are to stay still and silent, camouflaged from predators by its spotted coat. The mother returns at intervals to allow the fawn to suckle, and occasionally leads it to a new lying-up site.

EARTHY HUES

Commonly brown with white spots as here, the fallow deer can also be pale brown, black, or white.



*Axis axis*

Axis deer



Location S. Asia

Length 4.5–5 ft (1.4–1.5 m)

Tail 10–12 in (25–30 cm)

Weight 100–188 lb (45–85 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



Also called the chital, the axis deer lives in large herds of 100 or more, comprised of mixed males, females, and young. They graze in grassland and browse in open woodland, often below troops of langurs (see p.149), who knock fruit to the ground and emit warning calls. Axis deer dash for thick cover at 40 mph (65 kph) when disturbed. The male’s antler has one brow tine (prong), and a rear-directed main beam that forks into two points.

*Rusa unicolor*

Sambar



Location S. and S.E. Asia

Length 5¼–7 ft (1.6–2.1 m)

Tail 10–13 in (25–33 cm)

Weight 285–595 lb (130–270 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Vulnerable



The sambar is dark brown except for rusty hues on the chin, inner legs, and tail underside (which has a black tip). The male’s 3-point antlers grow to 4 ft (1.2 m) long. Both sexes have a neck mane of thicker fur; this is more prominent in rutting males. Solitary, except for a female with a fawn, and perhaps a yearling, too, these nocturnal deer eat a variety of vegetation.